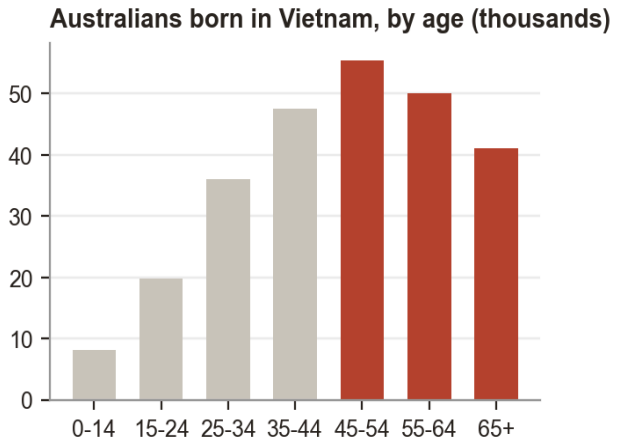
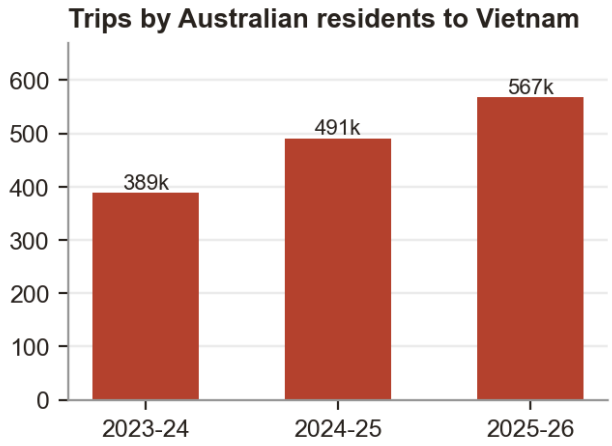
Medical Travel to Vietnam: Sizing the Vietnamese-Australian Market

Daniel Bui · Research completed in 2025, public version November 2026 · Public data only

There are **257,997** Australians born in Vietnam and **334,785** with Vietnamese ancestry (ABS Census 2021). **57%** of those born in Vietnam are aged 45 or over, and trips by Australian residents to Vietnam grew **46%** in two years. Common procedures cost far less in Vietnam than in Australia (about **81%** less for dental work), which makes a combined family-visit and health-care trip a realistic product for this group.

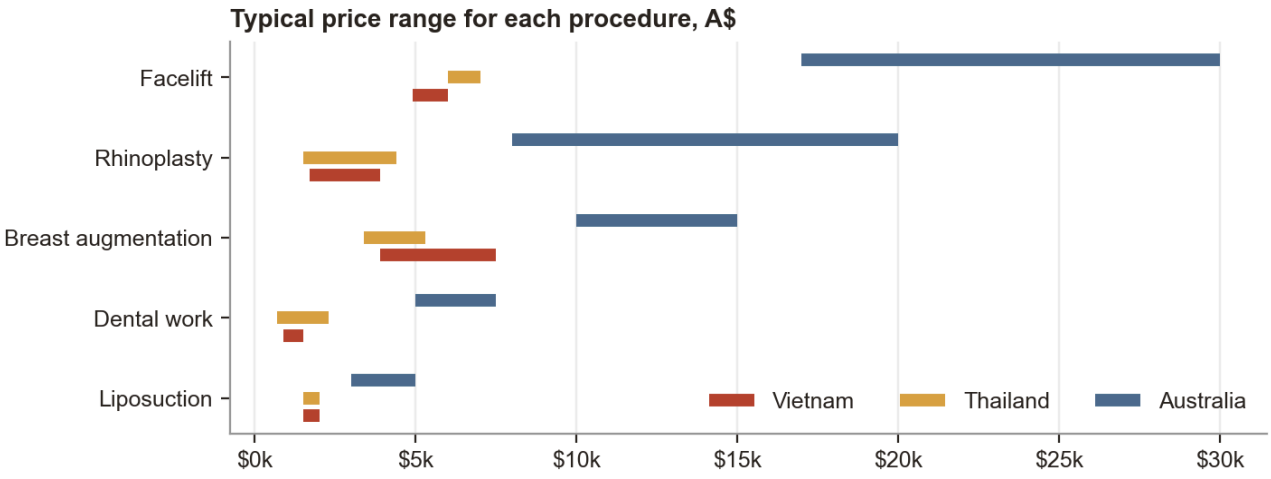
Who the customers are





- **An older, established community.** The median age of Vietnam-born Australians is 48, against 38 for all Australians, and 56% are women. 146,665 people, 57% of the group, are 45 or older: the ages when health checks, dental work and specialist care become regular needs.
- **They already travel to Vietnam.** Australian residents made 567,480 trips to Vietnam in 2025-26, up from 388,580 in 2023-24. Many are visits to family, so health care can be added to a trip people take anyway.
- **Australians already go abroad for treatment.** An estimated 15,000 Australians a year travel overseas for procedures such as dental implants and cosmetic surgery, and dental care is the most common reason.

Price: why Vietnam is attractive



Procedure	Vietnam saving vs Australia (midpoints)
Dental work	81%
Rhinoplasty	80%
Facelift	77%
Liposuction	56%
Breast augmentation	54%

Vietnam is far cheaper than Australia for every procedure compared, and close to Thailand. Thailand is cheaper for breast augmentation and at the low end of dental prices, so price alone does not win against Thailand: service, trust and the family connection have to.

Vietnam against Thailand

Measure	Vietnam	Thailand
Foreign patients a year	About 300,000	About 3.07 million (2024 estimate)
Medical tourism market	US$722 million (2024)	US$2.57 billion (2023)
Expected growth	17.8% a year to 2033	10.5% a year to 2030
JCI-accredited hospitals	A few, including FV and Vinmec	61 (October 2023)
Known for	Dental, fertility, paediatric surgery	Cosmetic, dental, orthopaedic, cardiac, wellness

Thailand is the established destination for Australian patients, with ten times the foreign patients and many more internationally accredited hospitals. Vietnam's market is smaller but growing faster, and Vietnamese-Australians bring something Thailand cannot offer: family in Vietnam and a language they share with doctors and staff.

Recommendation

- **Target customer:** Vietnamese-Australians aged 45 and over who already visit family in Vietnam.
- **Product:** a package that combines a family visit with booked health checks or dental care at internationally accredited hospitals, such as Vinmec or FV, with flexible dates and Vietnamese-speaking support.
- **What has to be true:** clear, fixed prices before travel, accredited hospitals, and help with follow-up care after the customer returns to Australia. These are the points where Thailand currently leads.

Method and limits

Population and age figures come directly from the ABS Census 2021 QuickStats for people born in Vietnam. Trip numbers are ABS Overseas Arrivals and Departures figures as reported by KarryOn; I did not access the ABS release tables directly. Price ranges are indicative ranges compiled from published clinic and medical-tourism price guides in 2025, not quotes. Market size and accreditation figures come from the industry reports named in the table. This public version uses public information only. The study grew out of my internship at Vietravel Australia (July to October 2025), which also included a survey of 53 Vietnamese-Australians; those responses are not published, to protect the respondents' privacy, and no Vietravel customer, pricing or partner information is included. Full data: github.com/leducthinhbui/medical-tourism-research.